# Harry Styles Rewinds to His 2010 Audition for Harryween

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Harry Styles took a trip back in time at Madison Square Garden on Friday, October 30 and he brought the audience with him.

On the 29th night of his 30-show Together, Together **residency**, Styles changed mid-show into the outfit he wore for his 2010 X Factor **audition**. Then he sang Stevie Wonder's 'Isn't She Lovely,' the song that helped him move on to the next round when he was 16. He even repeated a line from that day, telling the crowd, 'I work in a bakery,' a nod to the part-time job he held in his hometown of Holmes Chapel in Cheshire.

The **throwback** was not the night's only costume change. Styles opened the show dressed as Elvis Presley, while his band and dancers came dressed as different versions of Styles from across his career. The Elvis choice made sense: the first song Styles ever recorded was a cover of Presley's 'The Girl of My Best Friend.'

The **audition** story has a twist. 'Isn't She Lovely' was not Styles' first pick. Footage released by the show in 2022 showed he opened with Train's 'Hey, Soul Sister,' and only sang the Wonder song without a **backing track** after Simon Cowell asked to hear him that way. He was later placed in One Direction alongside Niall Horan, Louis Tomlinson, Zayn Malik and the late Liam Payne.

Costumed covers have become a Harryween tradition. At the first **edition**, at Madison Square Garden in 2021, Styles dressed as Dorothy to sing 'Over the Rainbow,' then came out as a clown the next night to cover Britney Spears' 'Toxic.' In 2022, at Los Angeles' Kia Forum, he dressed as Grease's Danny Zuko for 'Hopelessly Devoted to You.'

The **residency** wraps Saturday, October 31, with a final Harryween show.

## Word Treasure

**residency** -- A residency is a series of concerts by the same performer in one place over time.

**audition** -- An audition is a tryout where a performer sings or acts to show they are good enough for a part.

**backing track** -- A backing track is recorded music played behind a singer while they perform.

**throwback** -- A throwback is something from the past that is brought back or remembered.

**edition** -- An edition is one occurrence of an event that happens again and again.

## Background you need

The X Factor is a singing competition where hopeful performers sing in front of an audience and are either sent on to the next round or sent home.

Harry Styles first became widely known through that show, where he was placed with other young singers to form the group One Direction.

After the group, Styles built a solo career as a performer who tours and records his own music.

Harryween is his Halloween-themed concert tradition, where he dresses in costume and performs cover songs connected to that costume.

## Break it down

**LEAD:** At Madison Square Garden on Friday, October 30, Harry Styles revisited his 2010 X Factor audition during the 29th night of his 30-show Together, Together residency.

**KEY EVENT:** Mid-show costume change and audition re-creation

+- WHO: Harry Styles, with his band and dancers

+- WHAT: He changed into his 2010 audition outfit and sang Stevie Wonder's 'Isn't She Lovely'

+- WHEN: Friday, October 30, on the 29th night of the residency

+- DETAIL: He repeated 'I work in a bakery,' recalling his part-time job in Holmes Chapel in Cheshire when he was 16

**OPENING LOOK:** Styles opened the show dressed as Elvis Presley, while his band and dancers dressed as different versions of Styles

+- CONNECTION: The first song Styles ever recorded was a cover of Presley's 'The Girl of My Best Friend'

**AUDITION TWIST:** 'Isn't She Lovely' was not his first pick

+- EVIDENCE: Footage released by the show in 2022 showed he opened with Train's 'Hey, Soul Sister'

+- TURN: He sang the Wonder song without a backing track after Simon Cowell asked to hear him that way, and was later placed in One Direction alongside Niall Horan, Louis Tomlinson, Zayn Malik and the late Liam Payne

**HARRYWEEN TRADITION:** Costumed covers from earlier editions

+- 2021 at Madison Square Garden: Dorothy for 'Over the Rainbow,' then a clown for Britney Spears' 'Toxic' the next night

+- 2022 at Los Angeles' Kia Forum: Grease's Danny Zuko for 'Hopelessly Devoted to You'

**CLOSING:** The residency wraps Saturday, October 31, with a final Harryween show

## Why it matters

It shows how an early audition moment can stay part of a performer's story years later, as artists and audiences revisit beginnings while a residency builds its own traditions.

## Test what you remember

1. **On Friday, October 30, what did Harry Styles change into mid-show?**
   - (A) A Dorothy costume
   - (B) An Elvis Presley costume
   - (C) The outfit he wore for his 2010 X Factor audition
   - (D) A clown costume
2. **Which song did Styles sing after changing into his audition outfit?**
   - (A) Over the Rainbow
   - (B) Hey, Soul Sister
   - (C) Hopelessly Devoted to You
   - (D) Isn't She Lovely
3. **In which town did Styles hold the part-time bakery job he mentioned on stage?**
   - (A) Holmes Chapel in Cheshire
   - (B) Los Angeles
   - (C) Kia Forum
   - (D) Madison Square Garden
4. **According to footage released by the show in 2022, which song did Styles open his audition with?**
   - (A) Isn't She Lovely
   - (B) The Girl of My Best Friend
   - (C) Hey, Soul Sister
   - (D) Toxic
5. **Who asked Styles to sing 'Isn't She Lovely' without a backing track?**
   - (A) Zayn Malik
   - (B) Louis Tomlinson
   - (C) Simon Cowell
   - (D) Niall Horan
6. **At the 2022 Harryween show at Los Angeles' Kia Forum, which character did Styles dress as?**
   - (A) A clown
   - (B) Grease's Danny Zuko
   - (C) Elvis Presley
   - (D) Dorothy

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: A 4: C 5: C 6: B

# Questions to think about

## MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):